Honors Focus Area & Capstone Reflection (EGL)

1. Define "operations" in your own words? Why is it important for an engineer to develop an understanding of operations, regardless of specific engineering major?

   Operations is how a company or an organization manages its resources and processes to make sure everything runs as efficiently as possible. It's important for an engineer to develop an understanding of operations because engineering isn't just about creating something but rather understanding how it can be used in the real world. Understanding operations makes sure that the project that you're working with is feasible in the real world. Another reason is that engineering decisions should be taken keeping operations in mind if you want an efficient process.

2. What are you hoping to gain from the Tauber Institute for Global Operations experience?

   I hope to gain real-world experience and a better understanding of how engineering relates to business. I want to be able to apply what I'm learning in a classroom environment to solve actual problems that people and companies face. I also hope to improve my teamwork and communication skills. I am still exploring what career path I want to pursue, so I think this experience will help me discover different opportunities and prepare me for a successful career after graduation.

3. Rank the capstone types in order of your current interest. Rank "Global Business/Operations" as #1 and then indicate how you would rank the other areas, if you were not pursuing EGL.

Research	____2____
Design	____3____
Entrepreneurship	____4____
Global Business/Operations	____1____
Public Service	____5____

4. How did you decide which choice to rank as #2 above?

   I ranked Research as my second option because I am interested in pursuing a master's or even a PhD in mechanical engineering or materials science and engineering in the future. I think research would give me the opportunity to explore topics in my major more deeply, develop critical thinking skills, and learn how to investigate and solve complex problems. I would like to gain more experience with research to see if it's something I want to pursue long-term.

5. In SMART goal format, list three specific things you will do to explore either the Global Business/Operations capstone and associated coursework or the other capstone types.

1- Researching past projects: Within the next month, I will research at least three more previous Global Business/Operations capstone projects to learn more about the types of real-world problems students have worked on and the companies they have partnered with.

2- Learn more about PhD programs: Before the end of the semester, I will research at least three Mechanical Engineering PhD programs to understand their requirements, research opportunities, and the academic path needed to pursue a doctorate.

3- Explore operations-related careers: Within the next two months, I will research at least three careers related to engineering operations, such as operations engineering, supply chain management, and project management, to better understand their responsibilities and qualifications.